

Slippery scales

Most fishes have a smooth body covered with scales. These help to protect the fish's body.

Fishes first appeared on the Earth 500 million years ago.

Quick quiz



Where are the gills on a fish's body?



What do the feathery filaments do?



Can sea mammals breathe under water?

Breathing through blowholes

Not all sea creatures breathe using gills. Whales are mammals with lungs and so they must swim to the surface to breathe air. Whales draw in air and blow it out through blowholes on the top of their heads.

